

Published edition vs AI-assisted build

A page-by-page and field-by-field comparison of the printed September edition against the automated build. Draft 4 closes the race programs gap that blocked Draft 2 and Draft 3. What remains is a short list of data variances, one modelling gap around feature race nominations, and a set of naming and styling decisions to settle with Comms.

REFERENCE — PUBLISHED IRSEP26V5_FA4.pdf 61 pages · InDesign 21.5 · modified 2 Sep 2026	UNDER TEST — AUTOMATED Inside Racing September 2026 Draft 4.pdf 68 pages · HTML to PDF · generated 9 Sep 2026
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HEADLINE NUMBERS

RACE PROGRAMS 134 / 131 Meeting blocks. Now runs the full 1 Sep to 30 Nov range across pp.27-51.	PROGRAMS SUMMARY CHART 126 / 126 Meetings present, in identical order, pp.6-26. Two prizemoney figures differ.	PERMITS & AGENTS 100% 37 apprentice rows and 38 agent rows reproduced field for field.	EXTENT 68 pp vs 61 published. Eight advertising slots reserved, six partial and two full page.
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FIXED SINCE DRAFT 2

Race Programs now runs to 30 November

Draft 2 and Draft 3 both stopped at Sat 7 Nov with 102 meeting blocks. Draft 4 carries 134 across 25 pages, covering every meeting the published edition carries and then some. This was the only blocking defect.

Draft 2/3: pp.27-46, 102 blocks | Draft 4: pp.27-51, 134 blocks |
Published: pp.27-49, 131 blocks

- **Entry deadlines rescoped to match.** Draft 2 ran the section to 30 November against the published edition’s October cut-off. Draft 4 now stops at 30 October and the running head reads September-October, as published.
- **Permits wins snapshot date corrected** from 13/08/2026 to 14/08/2026 (landed in Draft 3).

- **Contents page now cites the right race programs range** (27-51).

Note that Draft 3 was a false start: it was identical to Draft 2 on 63 of 64 pages, pixel for pixel, carrying only the permits date change.

NEW IN DRAFT 4

DUPLICATED

RACE PROGRAMS · 17, 24 AND 31 OCTOBER

Three picnic meetings now appear in Race Programs as well as in the picnic table. The published edition carries picnic meetings only in the picnic programs grid.

DRAFT 4 ONLY

Yea 17 Oct · Alexandra 24 Oct · Healesville 31 Oct

TRUNCATED BLOCK

RACE PROGRAMS · P.51 · BET365 PARK KYNETON, MON 30 NOV

The final race entry has no conditions line beneath it, so the section still ends mid-item. The published edition ends the same meeting at a complete entry.

PUBLISHED

2. MAIDEN PLATE / Of \$32,000. Set Weights.



DRAFT 4

4. MAIDEN PLATE (nothing follows)

NAMING

RACE PROGRAMS · MEETING HEADINGS

Valley-managed meetings lose their “The Valley @” prefix across roughly nine meetings, and the Twilight suffix is dropped while Night is retained.

PUBLISHED

THE VALLEY @ SOUTHSIDE CRANBOURNE (NIGHT) · WARRNAMBOOL (TWILIGHT)



DRAFT 4

SOUTHSIDE CRANBOURNE (NIGHT) · WARRNAMBOOL

AD INVENTORY

END OF RACE PROGRAMS

The published edition closes the section with a half-page advertisement on p.49. Draft 4 reserves no slot there and leaves the space empty. Full-page slots are down from three to two.

Every item below is unchanged from Draft 2 and was reconfirmed against Draft 4. All were verified against the rendered pages of both documents.

WRONG FIGURE	PROGRAMS SUMMARY CHART · SAT 19 SEP · CAULFIELD G1 Sir Rupert Clarke Stakes prizemoney is understated by \$1,000. PUBLISHED \$1,004,900 1400m → DRAFT 4 \$1,003,900 1400m
WRONG FIGURE	PROGRAMS SUMMARY CHART · SAT 12 SEP · FLEMINGTON G3 Archer Stakes prizemoney differs by \$110. PUBLISHED \$304,610 2500m → DRAFT 4 \$304,500 2500m
WRONG FIGURE	RACE SERIES · MRC GRAND HANDICAP 2400M · HEAT 5 Cranbourne heat prizemoney understated by \$25,000. PUBLISHED \$60k BM70 Handicap 2025m → DRAFT 4 \$35k BM70 Handicap 2025m
WRONG FIGURE	RACE SERIES · VRC GRAND HANDICAP SPRINT · HEAT 7 Sale heat prizemoney understated by \$5,000. The Horsham Cup heat also prints as “\$65” rather than “\$65k”. PUBLISHED \$40k BM70 Handicap 1200m → DRAFT 4 \$35k BM70 Handicap 1200m
WRONG DATE	PICNIC PROGRAMS · FIRST MEETING The opening Yea picnic meeting is dated a week early. PUBLISHED 17-OCT-26 YEA → DRAFT 4 10-OCT-26 YEA
WRONG DAY	RACE SERIES · EMERGING STARS SERIES · HEATS 6 AND 7 Two heats carry the wrong weekday against a correct date. 7 November 2026 is a Saturday and 11 November is a Wednesday. PUBLISHED Sat 7 Nov / Wed 11 Nov → DRAFT 4 Fri 7 Nov / Fri 11 Nov

MISSING ROW

RACE SERIES · HIGHWEIGHT SCHEDULE

The Jericho Cup is absent, and the 1 October Warrnambool maiden appears twice, so the table has the right row count for the wrong reason.

PUBLISHED Sun 29 Nov Warrnambool Jericho Cup 4600m	→
DRAFT 4 absent; “Thu 1 Oct Warrnambool Maiden Plate 1700m” duplicated	

MISSING ENTRY

PERMITS · ELIGIBLE TO RIDE IN TRIALS

Nine of the ten listed riders carry through. One apprentice is dropped.

PUBLISHED 10 riders, incl. NATASHA MCMAHON 0400 654 875	→	DRAFT 4 9 riders
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MISSING CELLS

PICNIC PROGRAMS · RESTRICTED TROPHY COLUMN 3

Two Restricted Trophy races drop out of the grid entirely.

PUBLISHED Yea \$5,000 1000m / Alexandra \$5,000 1300m	→	DRAFT 4 both cells empty
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WRONG TIME

ENTRY DEADLINES · THU 15 OCT · RIDERS

Yea picnic riders deadline is an hour later than published.

PUBLISHED Yea P 12.00pm (17 October)	→	DRAFT 4 Yea P 1.00pm (17 October)
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MISSING DAY

ENTRY DEADLINES · SAT 31 OCTOBER

Melbourne Cup final acceptance day is absent from the deadlines section entirely.

EXTRA CONTENT

JUMP-OUT SCHEDULE · SEPTEMBER COLUMN

An August jump-out appears in the September list, and 15 Sep Pakenham falls to the bottom of the column out of date order.

DRAFT 4 ONLY 31-Aug-26 Casterton
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EXTRA CONTENT**OFFICIAL FLAT TRIALS**

An additional trial meeting is included, which is what pushes the section onto a second page. Race titles within the 7 September Cranbourne block are also generic where the published edition qualifies them, and the running order differs.

DRAFT 4 ONLY

CRANBOURNE-TRN MONDAY, 14 SEPTEMBER 2026

EXTRA CONTENT**NOTICES · P.64**

An extra notices page that the contents does not list. It repeats AR 79 and the mounting-yard notice already carried on the preceding spread, and adds three items not in the September edition at all.

DRAFT 4 ONLY

Embargoes and Veterinary Certificates · Stable Employee Registrations · LR 74A Overweight

EXTRA ENTRY**ENTRY DEADLINES · THU 10 SEP · ENTRIES**

An entry deadline appears that has no counterpart in the published edition.

DRAFT 4 ONLY

Cranbourne-Trn Trials 12.00pm (14 September)

STILL OPEN — FEATURE RACE NOMINATIONS

Unchanged in Draft 4, and the largest remaining structural difference. This is a modelling issue rather than a data error.

The published edition uses the full spring vocabulary of nomination milestones: *Feature Race Entry, Late Entry, 2nd Late Entry, 1st Acceptance, 2nd Acceptance, 3rd Acceptance, Final Acceptance*, and the combined *Late Entry and 1st Acceptance*. The automated build still recognises only two, *Entry* and *Acceptance*, and applies the standard Monday-entry, Wednesday-acceptance pattern to every feature race.

The consequence is that the staged spring nominations disappear and are replaced by a single generic pair that lands on a different day and time from the real deadline:

FEATURE RACE	PUBLISHED FINAL ACCEPTANCE	DRAFT 4 ACCEPTANCE
Ladbrokes Cox Plate	Tue 20 Oct, 12:00pm	Wed 21 Oct, 9.30am
Sportsbet Caulfield Guineas	Tue 6 Oct, 9:00am	Wed 7 Oct, 9.30am

FEATURE RACE	PUBLISHED FINAL ACCEPTANCE	DRAFT 4 ACCEPTANCE
Sportsbet Caulfield Cup	Tue 13 Oct, 9:00am	Wed 14 Oct, 9.30am
Lexus Melbourne Cup	Sat 31 Oct, 4:30pm	Fri 30 Oct, 9.15am

All the earlier milestones for these races — Melbourne Cup late entry on 15 September, Cox Plate 1st and 2nd acceptances on 8 and 22 September, and so on — are simply not present.

SECTION MAP

Section order holds until the back half, where Picnic and Jump-Outs swap position. The contents page still does not match its own body.

SECTION	PUBLISHED	DRAFT 4	NOTE
● Entry deadlines	3–5	3–5	Now Sep–Oct as published; 31 Oct still absent
● Programs summary chart	6–26	6–26	Page-for-page match
● Race programs	27–49	27–51	Full range; three picnic meetings duplicated in
● Permits / eligible for trials	50	52	One rider missing from the trials list
● Riders’ agents	51	53	Content identical
● Picnic programs	55–56	54–55	Ahead of Jump-Outs; renamed; dollar signs dropped
● Jump-outs & flat trials	53	56–57	Runs to a second page; extra trial meeting included
● Race series	54	58–59	Highweight schedule split onto its own page
● Industry notices	57–58	60–61	Both notices present; two on one spread instead of one per page
● From the Stewards’ Room	59	62–63	All five items present, over two pages
● Additional notices	—	64	Unlisted extra page not in the published edition

SECTION	PUBLISHED	DRAFT 4	NOTE
● HR Assist / back cover	60–61	65, 68	Retained; two full-page ad slots sit between

The Draft 4 contents page lists Jump-Outs at 54–55 when it sits on 56–57, Picnic at 56–57 when it sits on 54–55, and Division of Races at 54 when it sits on 56. The NZ Strangles industry notice is still not listed at all.

STILL OPEN — LAYOUT AND STYLING

Structurally the automated build is close. The chart and programs grids reproduce the published column structure, shading, distance bars and metro / country colour key. Everything below is unchanged from Draft 2.

- **Dollar signs are missing from the entire picnic programs table.** Every cell reads 5,000 1200m instead of \$5,000 1200m. Highly visible across two pages.
- **Long prizemoney figures break mid-number.** The Melbourne Cup cell wraps as \$10,200,00 / 0 3200m. The value is correct; the line breaking is not.
- **Section heading scale is inconsistent with the published edition.** The Programs Summary Chart title sets at roughly half the published size, and the picnic heading changes from all caps to sentence case.
- **Three names for one section.** Picnic is “Picnic Racing” in the contents, “Programs for Picnic Meetings Oct-Apr” as the heading, and “Picnic Program 2026-2027” in the published running head it replaced.
- **Typography differs from the brand set.** Meeting dates and venue names lose their condensed bold treatment, the metro red sits noticeably pinker than the published red, and the cover masthead and date band use a lighter, wider face.
- **The cover photograph is cropped wider,** so the lead horse sits smaller in the frame than in the published cover.
- **Bullet lists render as plain paragraphs** in the Strangles notice quarantine section.
- **The STABLELINE counselling panel is gone,** replaced by an advertising slot on page 26 and dropped from the contents page.
- **Race titles use commercial names.** Where the published edition prints “1. MAIDEN PLATE”, the automated build prints “1. SLEEP CLINICS MAIDEN PLATE”. Race order within a meeting also differs. This looks like a different source field rather than a fault, but it is a decision to make explicitly.

- **Venue naming is more literal.** Cranbourne Trials becomes Cranbourne-Trn Trials, Seymour Trials becomes bet365 Seymour Trials, Cranbourne becomes Southside Cranbourne, and feature races abbreviate STAKES to STKS while dropping sponsor prefixes.
- **Minor casing and abbreviation drift:** NIGHT to Night, TWILIGHT to Twilight, Handicap to Hcp, Stakes to Stks, C,G&E to Colts, Geldings.
- **One typo:** Penshurst becomes Penshust in the jump-out schedule. One grammatical slip: “a International training base”, plus a lost full stop, in the Melbourne Cup Carnival Series conditions.
- **One published error corrected.** A prizemoney figure printed as “55,000” without a dollar sign on 18 November renders correctly in the automated build.

WHAT CAME THROUGH CLEAN

Race Programs

Full 1 Sep to 30 Nov coverage across 25 pages, with the published edition’s column structure, distance bars, prizemoney breakdowns and balloting conditions.

Programs Summary Chart

All 126 meetings across pp.6–26, same order, same page breaks. Prizemoney, distances, class conditions and VOBIS flags match on every meeting but two.

Permits to ride in races

All 37 apprentices with weights, categories, masters, three contact numbers, expiry dates, allowances and six win columns — identical throughout.

Riders’ Agents

All 38 agents and every rider allocation and contact number reproduced exactly. Only the vertical alignment of the agent name differs.

Industry notices

Both September notices carried in full, word for word, including the exemptions and 12-month layoff provisions.

From the Stewards’ Room

All five items present and complete: AR 287, AR 79 bleeders, horses returning from overseas, mounting yard phones, offensive emails.

WHERE TO FOCUS NEXT

- **Scope rules, not coverage.** With the range fixed, the remaining structural work is filtering: exclude picnic meetings from Race Programs, exclude the extra flat trial meeting and the extra notices page, and include 31 October in the deadlines.
- **Model the feature race nomination types.** Late entry and staged acceptances are the spring carnival’s most consequential dates and the current logic cannot express them. This is now the single largest content gap.
- **Add a reconciliation check.** Row counts, date ranges and duplicate detection would have caught the Jericho Cup, the duplicated highweight row, the missing trials rider and the extra notices page automatically. A check that every race entry has a conditions line would have caught the p.51 truncation.

- **Trace the four prizemoney variances.** Four wrong figures out of several thousand is a good rate, but they suggest the automated build is reading a different or earlier snapshot of the same source.
- **Settle the naming and styling questions with Comms.** Commercial race names, sponsor-prefixed venues, The Valley and Twilight suffixes, section titles, and the brand type and colour set are decisions, not defects, but they need to be locked before this goes in front of reviewers.

Comparison performed on the supplied PDFs only. Text and layout were extracted programmatically and every difference cited was confirmed against the rendered pages of both documents.

Draft 3 is not treated separately: it was identical to Draft 2 on 63 of 64 pages, pixel for pixel, and carried only the permits wins-date correction.

Advertising is excluded from scope: the automated build reserves slots rather than placing artwork.

Racing Victoria · internal · requires human review before use in any decision or publication.